

world's largest provider of generic drugs, with 20 per cent of global exports in terms of volume, according to India Brand Equity Foundation (IBEF), the branding and communications body for trade and exports under the commerce and industry ministry.

Now it's up to India's corporates to grab big roles in the world pharma play.

Satish Reddy, Chairman of Dr. Reddy's Laboratories Ltd, India's second-largest pharma major by gross sales, says, "India's G20 presidency plays a crucial role in strengthening the nation's identity as the world's pharma hub."

The G20, a forum of the world's advanced economies—including the European Union—and developing countries, currently has 23 members, which account for 85 per cent of the world's GDP. It meets annually to discuss global issues.

Many Indian companies exporting generic products have cleared the US Food & Drug Administration's quality standards, allowing them entry into the world's biggest markets for generic drugs.

India is also scaling up its medical education sector, which has no shortage of students trying to get a berth (this year, 1.68 million will be jostling for 104,333 seats in 681 MBBS colleges at the qualifying NEET exam).

It has already met the World Health Organization's ideal ratio of one doctor for a thousand people with its current ratio at 1:834. But, India's ratio counts 565,000 AYUSH doctors, or those practising traditional medicine and homoeopathy.

For Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the one-year G20 presidency, which ends on November 30, 2023, allows India to focus on three priorities in healthcare: preventing and responding to health emergencies, strengthening co-operation in the pharmaceuticals sector—in which India has built an enviable production base—and digitalising health innovations aimed at universal coverage.

"The G20 summit acts as a platform that brings like-minded people and stakeholders together to discuss potential opportunities for international collaborations for an effective global healthcare ecosystem," says Reddy.

According to data analysis website Statista, the healthcare sector in India got over \$33 billion as FDI from April 2000 to March 2023. In this sector, drugs and pharmaceuticals grabbed the biggest share.

Glenn Saldanha, Chairman and Managing

CHECKING THE PULSE



During India's G20 presidency, PM Narendra Modi has driven an ambitious healthcare agenda



G20 healthcare priorities are pharma partnership, healthcare emergencies, and digital health



The G20 presidency also elevates India's role as a global pharmaceuticals hub



The spotlight falls on medical tourism and healthcare digitalisation



G20 countries are working together to shape global health solutions and advance medical technology